THINKER HUB

Course Structure & Curriculum Specification Guide for Instructors

Document Version 2.4 | Academic Year 2026/2027 | Audience: Faculty, Instructors, Course Creators

FACULTY STANDARD OF EXCELLENCE

At Thinker HUB, courses are outcome-driven, project-based, and mastery-focused. Instructors act as live industry mentors rather than passive video narrators. Every syllabus must empower students to graduate with production-grade portfolio artifacts, verified through continuous formative quizzes and hands-on coding/design challenges.

1.0 Architectural Overview of a Thinker HUB Course

Every course published in the Thinker HUB catalog is structured around 6 foundational layers to maximize student comprehension, engagement, and career readiness:

1. 1. Course Identity & Metadata: Title, Unique Code, Short Summary, Narrative Overview, Cover Graphic.
2. 2. Multi-Tier Fee & Delivery Matrix: Group Cohorts (max 15) vs. 1-on-1 Mentorship across Beginner, Intermediate, and Advanced tiers.
3. 3. Prerequisites & 3-Tier Progression: Hardware/software specs and clear milestones from Beginner to Advanced.
4. 4. Modular Sections & Sequential Lessons: Structured modules with video lectures, reading guides, and hands-on laboratory workshops.
5. 5. Continuous Assessments & Grading: Formative quizzes (MCQs/Theory/Code) and practical homework assignments with rubrics.
6. 6. Live Cohorts & Capstone Project: Scheduled live mentorship sessions and a verifiable graduation portfolio project.

2.0 Detailed Field Specifications & Standards

2.1 Course Identification

Course Title: Must be engaging and action-oriented (e.g. "Full-Stack Web Development Mastery: From Zero to Cloud Deployed"). Avoid generic titles like "Web Basics".

Course Code: A unique uppercase identifier (2 to 5 letters + 3 numbers, e.g., WEB-101, PY-201, DATA-301). This code links courses, quizzes, and sessions during bulk imports.

Short Description: A concise 1 to 3 sentence elevator pitch for student catalog cards.

Detailed Overview: A comprehensive 2 to 4 paragraph narrative displayed in the student syllabus modal explaining philosophy, teaching pedagogy, target learner background, and real-world applicability.

Timeline: Total calendar weeks plus weekly time commitment (e.g. "8 Weeks (approx. 6–8 hours per week)").

2.2 Recommended Pricing Matrix (ZMW / Zambian Kwacha)

Thinker HUB courses support flexible multi-tier pricing based on delivery format and learner level:

Delivery Category	Learner Level	Standard Fee Range (ZMW)	Recommended Duration
Group Cohort (Max 15)	Beginner	K250 – K350	6 to 8 Weeks
Group Cohort (Max 15)	Intermediate	K350 – K500	6 to 8 Weeks
Group Cohort (Max 15)	Advanced	K500 – K750	8 to 10 Weeks
One-On-One Mentorship	Beginner	K450 – K600	6 to 8 Weeks
One-On-One Mentorship	Intermediate	K600 – K800	6 to 8 Weeks
One-On-One Mentorship	Advanced	K800 – K1,200	8 to 10 Weeks

2.3 Level Progression Milestones

Beginner Phase: Syntax, environment setup, core concepts, and guided scaffolding exercises.

Intermediate Phase: Modular development, REST APIs, database persistence, and team workflow.

Advanced Phase: Production security, edge-case debugging, optimization, and autonomous capstone implementation.

3.0 Curriculum Hierarchy: Sections & Lessons

Courses are divided into Course Sections (Modules) containing sequential Lessons. Each lesson can be configured with the following properties:

Video Lesson: High-definition pre-recorded conceptual walkthrough (YouTube Unlisted, Vimeo, or MP4 cloud stream). Default minimum watch completion threshold is 90%.

Reading Lesson: Rich text, technical diagrams, architectural cheat-sheets, or reference articles.

Lab / Workshop: Hands-on coding exercise, starter repository, or lab assignment.

Free Preview Toggle: Instructors can mark 1–2 introductory lessons as "Free Preview" to let prospective students sample the course before enrolling.

4.0 Assessment & Grading Strategy

Assessments must reinforce mastery, not just score students:

Quizzes: Multiple choice questions (auto-graded), conceptual short answers, or code debugging snippets. Recommended pass threshold is 50% for beginner tracks and 70% for advanced tracks. Include clear explanations for correct and incorrect choices.

Homework Assignments: Practical projects accounting for 60% of the final certification grade. Deliverables include GitHub repository links, live cloud URLs, or design files. Grading must follow a clear rubric: Functionality (40%), Code Quality (30%), UI/UX & Responsiveness (20%), and Documentation (10%). Grade within 72 hours with constructive feedback.

5.0 Live Classroom Sessions & Cohort Rhythm

Instructors lead scheduled live cohort sessions (typically 60–90 minutes each week) via Google Meet or Zoom. Immediately after class, instructors mark attendance in the Instructor Portal. Maintaining >= 80% attendance is required for student certification.

6.0 Course Submission Template (Fillable Worksheet for Instructors)

Instructors may copy and fill out the following template to submit their course for administrative review and publication:

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COURSE SUBMISSION WORKSHEET:

1. Course Title: [Insert engaging, outcome-driven title]
2. Unique Course Code: [e.g. CS-101, WEB-201]
3. Estimated Duration: [e.g. 8 Weeks (approx. 6-8 hours/week)]
4. Short Description (Catalog Summary): [1-3 sentences highlighting
key value]
5. Detailed Overview: [Pedagogy, target learner profile, practical
skills]
6. Hardware/Software Requirements: [Laptops, RAM, installed tools]
7. 3-Tier Level Progression:
   - Beginner Phase: [Foundations & Environment setup]
   - Intermediate Phase: [Application development & APIs]
   - Advanced Phase: [Production deployment & debugging]
8. Key Outcome: [Capstone project and portfolio deliverable]
9. Delivery Format & Fees:
   - Group Cohort (Fee & Level): [e.g. K350 | Beginner]
   - 1-on-1 Mentorship (Fee & Level): [e.g. K650 | Beginner]
10. Curriculum Modules:
   - Module 1: [Title] -> Lessons 1.1, 1.2, 1.3 -> Quiz Title
   - Module 2: [Title] -> Lessons 2.1, 2.2 -> Assignment Title
   - Module 3: [Title] -> Lessons 3.1, 3.2
   - Module 4: [Capstone Project Title & Scope]
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